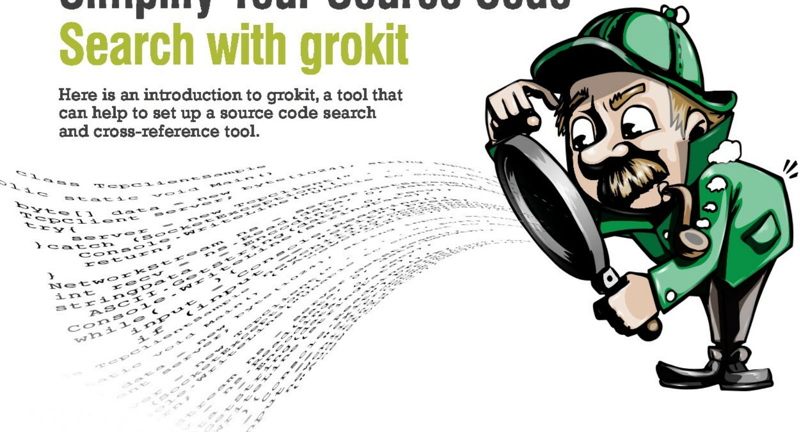
Simplify Your Source Code Search with grokit

Here is an introduction to grokit, a tool that can help to set up a source code search and cross-reference tool.



grokit is a developer's tool that is used to set up one of the best available source code search and cross-reference engines, Opengrok. This article gives an introduction to grokit and the motivation behind it, and explains how to use and explore it. grokit is written in Python.

grokit home page: http://grokit.pythonanywhere.com
grokit source code: https://github.com/raghusesha/grokit

Why is grokit needed?

There is nothing more frightening for a developer than to browse through thousands of lines of unfamiliar source code. If you have ever been in that situation, you have probably used Opengrok and know that it can help you alleviate the fear to a large extent. But, you would also know that setting up Opengrok itself is another dreaded task, from having the right versions of tools to modifying the appropriate xml files, and so on.

However, if you have not heard of Opengrok, it's fine. grokit was created to do the setting up for you.

In the following sections, we will look at how to use grokit to set up Opengrok for a project, and then have a peek inside grokit.

How to set up Opengrok using grokit

The instructions for setting up grokit are available at *http://grokit.pythonanywhere.com*

For Windows (32-bit), you can download the binaries for your platform and follow the instructions given below:

```
Unzip grokit_<platform>.zip
cd grokit
grokit.exe --ppath=<source path> --action=setup
```

An example is:

```
grokit.exe --ppath=d:\code\ffmpeg –action=setup
```

You can also watch the video 'How to set up Opengrok on Windows (in less than 2 minutes)' at *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BTGnZShDiqA*

For Linux (64-bit), the set-up instructions are:

```
tar -xvf grokit_<platform>.tar
cd grokit
./grokit --ppath=<source path> --action=setup
```

An example is:

```
./grokit --ppath=/home/user/ffmpeg --action=setup
```

Or, you can watch the video 'How to set up Opengrok on Linux (in less than 2 minutes)' at *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XzrPlAfiC1w*

Essentially, grokit is built on two principles—simplicity and independence.

Simplicity: The tool is extremely simple to use, with just a handful of options doing all the necessary tasks.